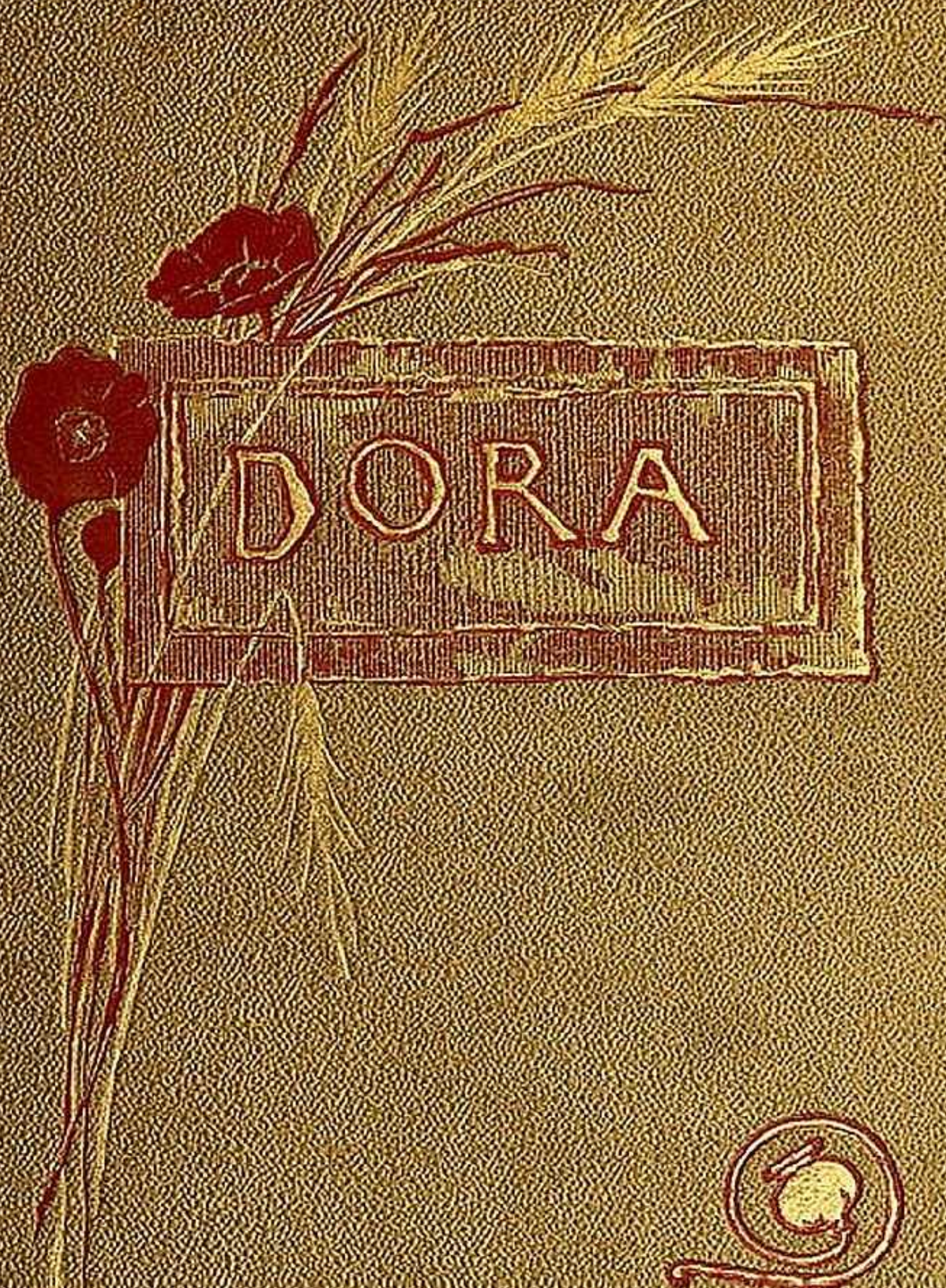


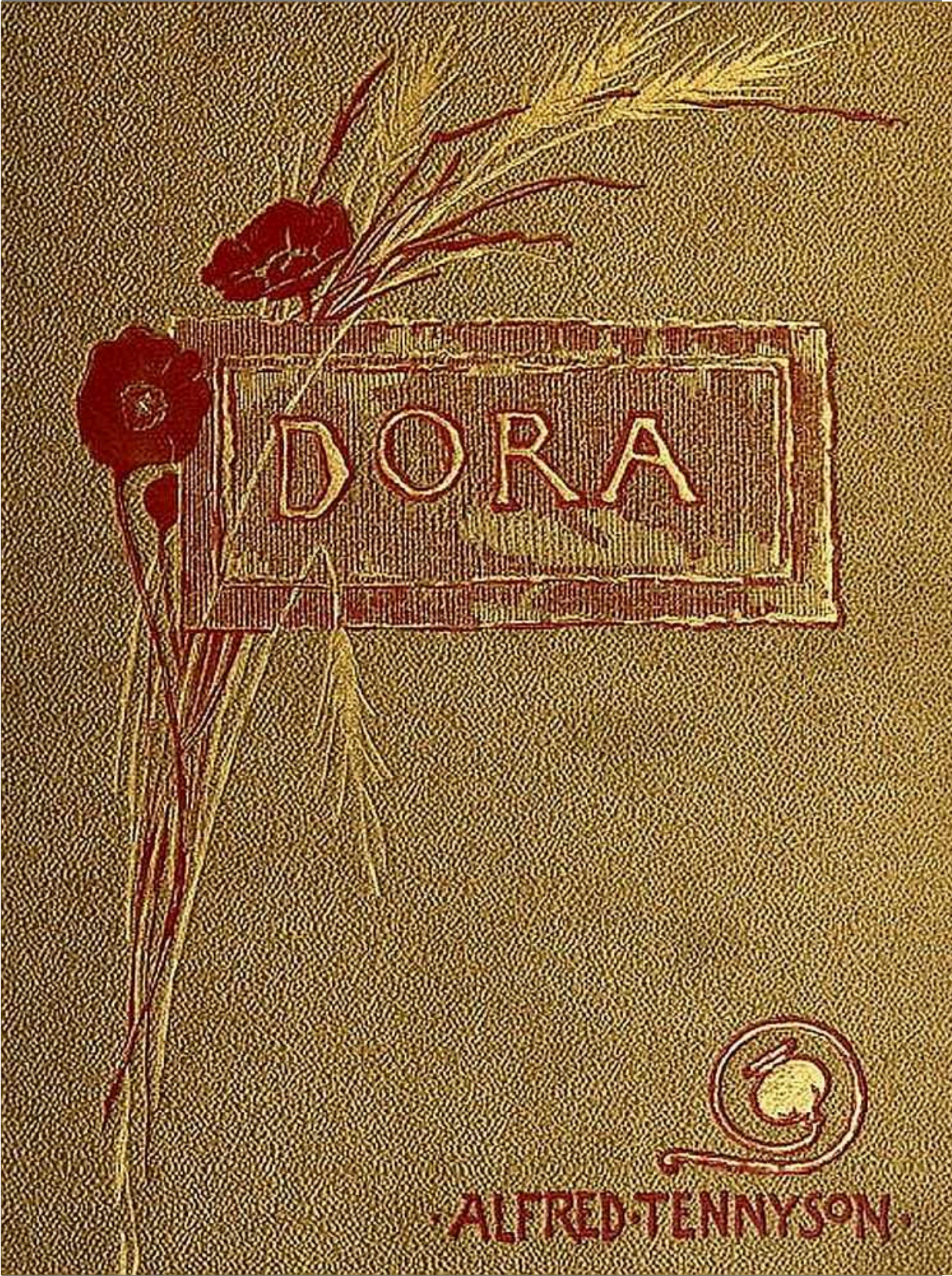
A decorative floral arrangement in the upper left corner, featuring a large red flower with a dark center, a smaller red flower, and a cluster of red buds. Long, thin, light-colored grass-like stems extend from the flowers across the top and down the left side of the cover.

DORA



ALFRED TENNYSON







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# DORA

BY

ALFRED TENNYSON

***ILLUSTRATED***

BOSTON  
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CHARLES T. DILLINGHAM  
1887

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**ILLUSTRATIONS BY W.L. TAYLOR.**

**DRAWN AND ENGRAVED UNDER THE SUPERVISION OF  
GEORGE T. ANDREW.**







WITH farmer Allan at the farm abode  
William and Dora. William was his son,  
And she his niece. He often look'd at them,  
And often thought, 'I'll make them man and  
wife.'

Now Dora felt her uncle's will in all,  
And yearn'd towards William; but the youth,  
because  
He had been always with her in the house,  
Thought not of Dora.

Then there came a day  
When Allan call'd his son, and said, 'My son:  
I married late, but I would wish to see  
My grandchild on my knees before I die:  
And I have set my heart upon a match.  
Now therefore look to Dora; she is well  
To look to; thrifty too beyond her age.  
She is my brother's daughter; he and I  
Had once hard words, and parted, and he died  
In foreign lands; but for his sake I bred  
His daughter Dora: take her for your wife;  
For I have wish'd this marriage, night and day,  
For many years.' But William answer'd short;  
'I cannot marry Dora; by my life,  
I will not marry Dora.' Then the old man  
Was wroth, and doubled up his hands, and said:  
'You will not, boy! you dare to answer thus!  
But in my time a father's word was law,  
And so it shall be now for me. Look to it;  
Consider, William: take a month to think,  
And let me have an answer to my wish;  
Or, by the Lord that made me, you shall pack,  
And never more darken my doors again.'







But William answer'd madly; bit his lips,  
And broke away. The more he look'd at her  
The less he liked her; and his ways were harsh;  
But Dora bore them meekly. Then before  
The month was out he left his father's house,  
And hired himself to work within the fields;  
And half in love, half spite, he woo'd and wed  
A laborer's daughter, Mary Morrison.



Then, when the bells were ringing, Allan call'd  
His niece and said: 'My girl, I love you well;  
But if you speak with him that was my son,  
Or change a word with her he calls his wife,  
My home is none of yours. My will is law,'  
And Dora promised, being meek. She thought,  
'It cannot be: my uncle's mind will change!'





And days went on, and there was born a boy  
To William; then distresses came on him;  
And day by day he pass'd his father's gate,  
Heart-broken, and his father help'd him not.  
But Dora stored what little she could save,  
And sent it them by stealth, nor did they know  
Who sent it; till at last a fever seized  
On William, and in harvest time he died.

Then Dora went to Mary. Mary sat  
And look'd with tears upon her boy, and thought  
Hard things of Dora. Dora came and said:  
    'I have obey'd my uncle until now,  
And I have sinn'd, for it was all thro' me  
This evil came on William at the first.





But, Mary, for the sake of him that's gone,  
And for your sake, the woman that he chose,  
And for this orphan, I am come to you:  
You know there has not been for these five years  
So full a harvest: let me take the boy,  
And I will set him in my uncle's eye  
Among the wheat; that when his heart is glad  
Of the full harvest, he may see the boy,  
And bless him for the sake of him that's gone.'

And Dora took the child, and went her way  
Across the wheat, and sat upon a mound  
That was unsown, where many poppies grew.  
Far off the farmer came into the field  
And spied her not; for none of all his men  
Dare tell him Dora waited with the child;  
And Dora would have risen and gone to him,  
But her heart fail'd her; and the reapers reap'd,  
And the sun fell, and all the land was dark.



But when the morrow came she rose and took  
The child once more, and sat upon the mound;  
And made a little wreath of all the flowers  
That grew about, and tied it round his hat,  
To make him pleasing in her uncle's eye.





Then when the farmer pass'd into the field  
He spied her, and he left his men at work,  
And came and said: 'Where were you yesterday?  
Whose child is that? What are you doing here?'  
So Dora cast her eyes upon the ground,  
And answer'd softly, 'This is William's child!'—  
'And did I not,' said Allan, 'did I not  
Forbid you, Dora?' Dora said again:  
'Do with me as you will, but take the child,  
And bless him for the sake of him that's gone!'



And Allan said, 'I see it is a trick  
Got up betwixt you and the woman there.  
I must be taught my duty, and by you!  
You knew my word was law, and yet you dared  
To slight it. Well—for I will take the boy;  
But go you hence, and never see me more.'





So saying, he took the boy, that cried aloud  
And struggled hard. The wreath of flowers fell  
At Dora's feet. She bow'd upon her hands,  
And the boy's cry came to her from the field,  
More and more distant.

She bow'd down her head,  
Remembering the day when first she came,  
And all the things that had been.



She bow'd down  
And wept in secret; and the reapers reap'd,  
And the sun fell, and all the land was dark.





Then Dora went to Mary's house, and stood  
Upon the threshold. Mary saw the boy  
Was not with Dora. She broke out in praise  
To God, that help'd her in her widowhood.  
And Dora said, 'My uncle took the boy;  
But, Mary, let me live and work with you:  
He says that he will never see me more.'  
Then answer'd Mary, 'This shall never be,  
That thou shouldst take my trouble on thyself:  
And, now I think, he shall not have the boy,  
For he will teach him hardness, and to slight  
His mother; therefore thou and I will go,  
And I will have my boy, and bring him home;  
And I will beg of him to take thee back;  
But if he will not take thee back again,  
Then thou and I will live within one house,  
And work for William's child, until he grows  
Of age to help us.'

So the women kiss'd  
Each other, and set out, and reach'd the farm.  
The door was off the latch: they peep'd and saw  
The boy set up betwixt his grandsire's knees,  
Who thrust him in the hollows of his arm,  
And clapt him on the hands and on the cheeks,  
Like one that loved him: and the lad stretch'd  
out  
And babbled for the golden seal, that hung  
From Allan's watch, and sparkled by the fire.  
Then they came in: but when the boy beheld  
His mother, he cried out to come to her:  
And Allan set him down, and Mary said:



'O father!—if you let me call you so—  
I never came a-begging for myself,  
Or William, or this child; but now I come





For Dora: take her back; she loves you well.  
O Sir, when William died, he died at peace  
With all men; for I ask'd him, and he said,  
He could not ever rue his marrying me—  
I had been a patient wife: but, Sir, he said  
That he was wrong to cross his father thus:  
"God bless him!" he said, "and may he never  
know

The troubles I have gone thro'!" Then he turn'd  
His face and pass'd—unhappy that I am!  
But now, sir, let me have my boy, for you  
Will make him hard, and he will learn to slight  
His father's memory; and take Dora back,  
And let all this be as it was before.'

So Mary said, and Dora hid her face  
By Mary. There was silence in the room;

And all at once the old man burst in sobs;  
'I have been to blame—to blame. I have  
kill'd my son.  
I have kill'd him—but I loved him—my dear  
son.  
May God forgive me!—I have been to blame.  
Kiss me, my children.'

Then they clung about  
The old man's neck, and kiss'd him many times,  
And all the man was broken with remorse;  
And all his love came back a hundred fold;  
And for three hours he sobb'd o'er William's  
child  
Thinking of William.





So those four abode  
Within one house together; and, as years  
Went forward, Mary took another mate;  
But Dora lived unmarried till her death.





\*\*\* END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK DORA \*\*\*

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